SCHEDULE MANAGEMENT PLAN

LITPATH AI: SMART PATHFINDER FOR THESES AND DISSERTATIONS

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INTRODUCTION

The LitPath AI project is a standalone AI-powered web application developed for the DOST-STII Library. It helps researchers search for theses and dissertations using smart search technology, including vector embeddings and large language models, instead of the traditional keyword-only OPAC system.

This Schedule Management Plan explains how the project team plans, tracks, and manages the project timeline from start to finish. It covers how the schedule is created, how progress is monitored, and how any changes to the timeline are handled.

It is important to note that LitPath AI is developed by a team of dedicated full-time students. Development activities are primarily conducted during weekday evenings (typically 4 to 6 hours per session), with additional progress made during occasional weekend morning sessions. The schedule is thoughtfully aligned with academic commitments, ensuring a sustainable and consistent workflow. Task estimates are planned to reflect this balanced approach, allowing the team to maintain productivity while effectively managing their academic responsibilities.

SCHEDULE MANAGEMENT APPROACH

The project schedule is managed using OpenProject, a web-based project management tool that supports Gantt charts, task tracking, milestones, and team assignments. OpenProject allows the team to plan tasks, assign them to team members, set due dates, and track completion in real time.

The schedule is built starting from the deliverables defined in the project's Work Breakdown Structure (WBS). From there, the team follows these steps:

- Activity Definition — The team identifies the specific tasks needed to complete each deliverable. For example, under backend development, tasks include setting up the vector search engine, integrating the LLM API, and testing AI outputs.
- Activity Sequencing — Tasks are arranged in the correct order based on which ones must be completed first. Dependencies are clearly marked in OpenProject.
- Duration Estimating — The team estimates how long each task will take based on its complexity and the team's available working hours. Given that members are students, estimates account for evening-only weekday sessions (4 to 6 hours) and occasional half-day weekend work.
- Resource Assignment — Tasks are assigned to team members based on their roles. Jenine and Charijoy handle development tasks, while Joshua handles quality assurance and testing.

Once a draft schedule is created, the whole team reviews it to confirm that task assignments, timelines, and sequencing are realistic given their availability. After the team agrees, the Project Sponsor reviews and approves the schedule before it is finalized (baselined).

a. Working Hours and Capacity

Since all team members are full-time students, the project follows a part-time working schedule. The table below summarizes the team's typical working capacity:

Timeframe	Availability & Application	Assigned Value
Weekly	Part-time allocation per project resource	10 hours per week
Monthly	Based on a standard 4-week month	40 hours per month
Costing	Standard flat rate applied in OpenProject	Php 500.00 per hour

All task duration estimates and resource costs in the schedule are based on this established capacity. For example, a task requiring 20 hours of effort would realistically take a single team member a minimum of 2 full weeks to complete, as they cannot exceed the 10-hour weekly limit. This distinction is critical when reading the OpenProject timeline, distributing workload, and calculating the project budget.

b. Project Milestones

The following milestones mark the key checkpoints of the LitPath AI project:

Milestone	Target Date	Status
Project Scoping	April 2025	Completed
Information Gathering	April 2025	Completed
Completion of Project Deliverables & Documentation	June 2025	Completed
Design Thinking Process (Stages 1–5)	Aug 2025	Completed
Core UI Development (System UI, Citation Generator, Bookmark)	Sep – Oct 2025	Completed
AI Search Engine, Generate Overview, Feedback Mechanism & Admin Dashboard	Oct 2025 – Jan 2026	Completed
Feature Refinement & Client Feedback Integration	Feb – Mar 2026	Completed
Continued Development & Performance Optimization (incl. codebase restructuring)	Mar – Apr 2026	In Progress

Proxmox Server Deployment & Internal Testing	Apr 2026	In Progress
Bug Fixes & Usability Testing	May – Jun 2026	Not Started
Final Deployment	Jun – Jul 2026	Not Started

c. Roles and Responsibilities in Schedule Development

Person Assigned	Role	Schedule Responsibilities
Tracie Tomon	Project Manager	Leads schedule development; creates and maintains the OpenProject schedule; validates with team; obtains sponsor approval; updates the schedule after each bi-weekly review.
Jenine Elaine Dulay	Developer	Participates in defining and estimating development tasks; performs assigned tasks; reports actual progress and any blockers to the Project Manager.
Charijoy Cempron	Developer	Participates in defining and estimating development tasks; performs assigned tasks; reports actual progress and any blockers to the Project Manager.
Joshua Sta Ana	QA / Tester	Defines and estimates testing tasks; executes test plans; documents bugs; reports QA outcomes to the Project Manager during bi-weekly reviews.
Khasian Eunice Romulo	Project Sponsor	Reviews and approves the final schedule before it is baselined; approves schedule change requests that exceed the defined threshold.
DOST-STII	Stakeholder / Client	Reviews the schedule against operational and deployment needs. All feedback is routed to the Project Sponsor, who then relays the updates and feedback to the project team via Viber.

SCHEDULE CONTROL

Schedule control means making sure the project stays on track throughout its lifecycle. This section explains how the team monitors progress, communicates updates, and responds to delays.

a. Monitoring Frequency

The project schedule is reviewed and updated every two weeks (bi-weekly). During each update, task owners report the following through the Microsoft Teams group chat or during a Teams meeting:

- Actual start dates
- Actual finish dates
- Completion percentage for tasks that are still in progress
- Any blockers or issues affecting the timeline

These updates are then entered into OpenProject by the Project Manager to keep the schedule current and visible to all team members.

b. Communication Channels

The team uses the following communication tools, depending on the audience:

Channel	Used For	Audience
Microsoft Teams (group chat)	Day-to-day coordination, task updates, sharing files, and quick questions	Project team (Tracie, Jenine, Charijoy, Joshua)
Microsoft Teams (meeting/call)	Bi-weekly schedule reviews, sprint planning, and issue discussions	Project team
Viber	Client updates, feedback sharing, and deployment coordination	Project Manager and DOST-STII client representative
OpenProject	Official schedule tracking, task assignments, milestone updates, and progress visibility	Entire project team

c. Roles and Responsibilities in Schedule Control

Role	Responsibilities
Project Manager	Facilitates bi-weekly review meetings on Teams; collects and records task updates; evaluates schedule variances; submits change requests when needed; communicates schedule status to the sponsor and to the client via Viber.
Development Team	Attends bi-weekly reviews via Teams; reports actual progress and completion percentages; flags potential delays early, especially when academic deadlines from other subjects are coming up; participates in finding solutions to schedule conflicts.

Project Sponsor	Stays informed of schedule status through regular reports from the Project Manager; reviews and approves schedule change requests that exceed the defined threshold.

SCHEDULE CHANGES AND THRESHOLDS

Not all delays or adjustments automatically require a formal change request. The team uses a 10% threshold rule to decide when a change needs to go to the Project Sponsor for approval.

a. Change Threshold

A formal Schedule Change Request must be submitted to the Project Sponsor if either of the following is true:

- A single task or work package is expected to take 10% more or 10% less time than originally planned.
- The overall project timeline is expected to increase or decrease by 10% or more from the baselined schedule.

Any adjustments that fall below these thresholds may be approved directly by the Project Manager without escalating to the Project Sponsor.

b. Change Request Process

Step	Who	What Happens
1	Team Member	Spots a potential delay or schedule issue and raises it in the Microsoft Teams group chat or during the bi-weekly review.
2	Project Manager + Team	Meet via Teams to review the issue; identify which tasks are affected; calculate the variance; and explore options such as reassigning tasks, reducing scope, or requesting more time.
3	Project Manager	Determines if the change exceeds the 10% threshold. If yes, a formal Schedule Change Request is prepared and submitted to the Project Sponsor for approval.
4	Project Sponsor	Reviews and approves or rejects the change request.
5	Project Manager	Updates the schedule in OpenProject and notifies the team via Teams chat. Communicates any impact to the Project Sponsor via Viber. Saves the approved change request in the project records.

SCOPE CHANGE

Occasionally, approved changes to what the project must deliver (scope changes) may significantly affect the schedule. For LitPath AI, this could happen when the DOST-STII client requests a new or revised feature, or when a technical discovery during development requires a different approach than originally planned.

If an approved scope change is expected to significantly affect the timeline, the Project Manager may request that the schedule be re-baselined — meaning the official reference schedule is reset to reflect the updated plan.

The process for handling scope-driven schedule changes is as follows:

- The Project Sponsor formally approves the scope change.
- The Project Manager and team evaluate how the change affects the current schedule and available working hours.
- If the impact is significant, the Project Manager submits a re-baselining request to the Project Sponsor.
- The Project Sponsor reviews and approves the request.
- The Project Manager updates the schedule in OpenProject and communicates the changes to the team via Teams and to the client via Viber.

Examples of scope changes that may trigger re-baselining in LitPath AI include adding a new feature to the AI search engine beyond what was originally agreed, significant redesign of the admin dashboard, or changes to the deployment environment that require additional setup and testing time. To prevent uncontrolled scope changes, all feature clarifications with the client must be documented and confirmed before development begins.

SPONSOR ACCEPTANCE

Approved by the Project Sponsor:

_____ Date: April 1, 2026

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